



- [Index](#)
- [Language ▾](#)
- [General ▾](#)
- [Business ▾](#)
- [Science ▾](#)
- [Mathematics And Applied Science ▾](#)
- [Home Economics ▾](#)
- [Civil And Mechanical ▾](#)

Chemistry Paper 3A WASSCE (SC), 2018

- [Subject Home](#)
- [1A](#)
- [2A](#)
- [3A](#)
- [1B](#)
- [2B](#)
- [3B](#)

Menu

[General](#)
[Comments](#)

[Weakness/
Remedies](#)

[Candidate's
Strength](#)

Question 2A

C and D are inorganic salts. Carry out the following exercises on them. Record your observations and identify any gas(es) evolved. State the conclusions you draw from the result of each test.

(a) Put all of C in a test tube and add about 5 cm³ of distilled water. Shake thoroughly and test the resulting solution with litmus paper. Divide the solution into three portions

- To the first portion, add NaOH (aq) in drops, then in excess.
- To the second portion, add NH₃ (aq) in drops, then in excess.
- To the third portion, add AgNO₃ (aq) followed by HCl (aq).

(b)(i) Put all of D in a test tube and add about 5 cm³ of distilled water. Shake thoroughly and feel the test tube.

(ii) To about 2 cm³ of the solution add HCl (aq)

[23 marks]

Observation

In part (a), majority of the candidates could not correctly deduce inferences from the observations. They wrote wrong cations.

In part (b), majority of the candidates did not write their observations when they felt the test tube.

The expected answers include:

	TEST	OBSERVATION	INFERENCE
(a)	C + distilled water + shaking Resulting solution + litmus paper	C dissolved to form a blue/greenish solution Solution turns blue litmus paper red	Solution is acidic

(i)	1st portion + NaOH(aq) in drops then in excess	Blue precipitate Precipitate insoluble in excess	Cu ²⁺ present
(ii)	2nd portion + NH ₃ (aq) in drops then in excess	(Light) <u>blue precipitate</u> (Do not accept deep blue ppt) Precipitate dissolves in excess to form a <u>deep blue solution</u>	Cu ²⁺ confirmed
(iii)	3rd portion + AgNO ₃ (aq) + HCl(aq)	White precipitate formed Precipitate insoluble (accept no visible reaction)	Cl ⁻ or CO ₃ ²⁻ S ²⁻ or SO ₃ ²⁻ Cl ⁻ present (Cl ⁻ must have been mentioned above)
(b) (i)	D + distilled water touching/feel	D dissolved to form a colourless solution Test tube feels cold on touching	dissolution is endothermic
(ii)	D(aq) + HCl(aq)	Effervescence a <u>colourless odourless</u> gas evolved. Gas turned lime water milky	CO ₂ from CO ₃ ²⁻ or HCO ₃ ⁻

[Prev](#)[Next](#)

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